58. McKercher, op. cit., pp. 80–1. T.G. Otte discusses the concept of 'political generations' and their differing perceptions of Britain's foreign relations. See: Otte, The Foreign Office Mind: The Making of British Foreign Policy, 1865–1914 (hereafter Foreign Office Mind).

59. Crowe, 'Memorandum on the Present State of British Relations with France and Germany', 1 Jan. 1907, in Gooch and Temperley, eds, British Documents on the Origins of the War , Vol. III, pp. 397–420.

60. McKercher, op. cit., p. 85.

61. Joll, 1914: The Unspoken Assumptions , p. 6.

62. Steiner, 'Elitism and Foreign Policy: The Foreign Office Before the Great War', in McKercher and Moss, eds, Shadow and Substance in British Foreign Policy, 1895–1939 , pp. 19–56.

63. Otte explores the nature of the Foreign Office mind further in his work on the pre-war period: Otte, Foreign Office Mind .

64. The role of the foreign secretary in the creation of foreign policy and the complexity of understanding how individuals within government influenced each other is explained further by Michael Hughes: Hughes, British Foreign Secretaries in an Uncertain World, 1919–1939 (hereafter Uncertain World).

65. For example: Darwin, 'The Fear of Falling: British Politics and Imperial Decline Since 1900', Transactions of the Royal Historical Society, Vol. 36 (1986), pp. 27-43 (hereafter 'Fear of Falling'); Cross, The Fall of the British Empire, 1918–1968 ; Hyam, Britain's Imperial Century 1815–1914 , 2nd ed; Dilks, ed., Retreat from Power: Studies in Britain's Foreign Policy of the Twentieth Century, Vol. One, 1906–1939 (hereafter Retreat).

66. For an insight into this preoccupation with economic decline, see Supple, 'Fear of Failing: Economic History and the Decline of Britain', in Clarke and Trebilock, eds, Understanding Decline: Perceptions and Realities of British Economic Performance , pp. 9–29.